

WEEKLY

EDICIÓN #37

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UNA SEMANA. UN NÚMERO.

WEEKLY existe porque internet produce demasiadas cosas interesantes como para intentar leerlas todas y demasiadas cosas absurdas como para dejar que el algoritmo decida por nosotros.

Esta revista junta las fuentes que elegiste, encuentra historias que merecen atención y las convierte en un número que se puede leer de principio a fin. No pretende ser neutral sobre lo que resulta interesante: pretende ser curiosa.

Aquí conviven videojuegos, cine, animación, tecnología, retro y todas esas cosas raras que terminan apareciendo cuando uno sigue un enlace porque decía que algo era prácticamente magia.

WEEKLY no quiere reemplazar a las fuentes originales. Quiere ser el lugar desde donde descubres qué vale la pena abrir. Cuando una historia está completa, la leemos aquí. Cuando una fuente solo permite ofrecer un resumen, te mandamos a leerla donde corresponde.

Una semana. Un número. Un montón de cosas interesantes.

Nos vemos la próxima semana.

WEEKLY · EDICIÓN CERRADA

HAMSTER Corporation | “Arcade Archives ARKANOID REVENGE OF DOH” Releases Sep 3 on Switch, Switch 2, PS4/5, Xbox Series X|S

There are some arcade games that simply don't need much introduction. ARKANOID is one of them. Originally released by Taito in 1986, the paddle-and-ball classic became one of the defining block-breaking games of the arcade era. Its 1987 sequel, ARKANOID: REVENGE OF DOH, took the basic formula and expanded it with new enemies, stage designs, [...] The post HAMSTER Corporation | “Arcade Archives ARKANOID REVENGE OF DOH” Releases Sep 3 on Switch, Switch 2, PS4/5, Xbox Series X|S appeared first on Old School Gamer Magazine .



by Todd Friedman | Sep 5, 2026 | 1990s , 2000s , Reviews

There are some arcade games that simply don't need much introduction. ARKANOID is one of them. Originally released by Taito in 1986, the paddle-and-ball classic became one of the defining block-breaking games of the arcade era. Its 1987 sequel, ARKANOID: REVENGE OF DOH , took the basic formula and expanded it with new enemies, stage designs, power-ups, and challenges.

Now HAMSTER Corporation has brought ARKANOID: REVENGE OF DOH to Nintendo Switch 2 as part of its Arcade Archives 2 series. Rather than completely remake the game for modern audiences, HAMSTER takes a preservation-first approach, keeping the original arcade experience intact while adding modern features that make the game considerably more convenient to play today.

The result is one of those releases that understands exactly what makes an old arcade game special. the ball, and advance through increasingly difficult stages.

The sequel adds considerably more variety to that formula. Blocks can move, regenerate, or behave differently, while enemies and obstacles make later stages much more challenging.

There is also a branching stage structure, allowing players to take different routes through the game.

Arcade Archives 2 Features

This is where HAMSTER's Switch 2 release becomes more than simply playing an old game on new hardware.

The release includes several different ways to play, including Original Mode, Hi Score Mode, Caravan Mode, and Time Attack Mode.

Time Attack is particularly interesting because it changes the objective. Instead of concentrating exclusively on score, you're trying to complete the game as quickly as possible.

There are also save features, online rankings, rewind functionality, and rapid-fire options.

These additions don't fundamentally change REVENGE OF DOH . Instead, they give modern players different ways to enjoy the original game.

That is exactly the approach I want to see from a classic-game collection.

At around the \$10 price point, this is an easy recommendation for classic arcade fans.

The value proposition is somewhat different for players who aren't interested in arcade history.

You're essentially buying a faithful recreation of a game that is nearly four decades old, rather than a brand-new Switch 2 production.

But for players who appreciate classic arcade gaming, that's precisely the appeal.

HAMSTER has preserved the original game while adding features that make it considerably easier to enjoy on modern hardware.

You must be logged in to post a comment.

LEER ORIGINAL · <https://www.oldschoolgamer magazine.com/hamster-corporation-arcade-archives-arkanoid-revenge-of-doh-releases-sep-3-on-switch-switch-2-ps4-5-xbox-series-xs/>

Atari and Vice Beer Introduce New Beer Collection

ATARI AND VICE BEER INTRODUCE NEW BEER COLLECTION The four-pack of Atari-themed beer is available now. September 5, 2026 – Atari and Vice Beer are celebrating a new licensing collaboration during PAX West in Seattle. Vancouver, Washington-based Vice Beer has released a four-pack of Atari-themed 16 oz. beers, including One-Button Joystick WC IPA, Gemstone Sour, [...] The post Atari and Vice Beer Introduce New Beer Collection appeared first on Old School Gamer Magazine .



by Old School Gamer | Sep 5, 2026 | 1980s , 1990s , Press Release

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The four-pack of Atari-themed beer is available now.

September 5, 2026 – Atari and Vice Beer are celebrating a new licensing collaboration during PAX West in Seattle. Vancouver, Washington-based Vice Beer has released a four-pack of Atari-themed 16 oz. beers, including One-Button Joystick WC IPA, Gemstone Sour, Sunken Treasure and Original Bug Battle Hazy IPA. The four-packs can be purchased online via atari.com or at shop.tavour.com .

"I remember the thrill of walking into an arcade with a pocket full of quarters, and that is how I feel sharing these hand-crafted, Atari-themed beers with fans," said Michael Perozzo, co-founder of Vice Beer. "There is something for everyone in this collection, and the artwork is satisfyingly retro."

The four-beer collection includes:

One-Button Joystick – 1x 16oz can – WCIPA – 6.9% ABV Featuring the absolutely iconic controller of the Atari 2600, Vice and Atari opted for a suitable craft classic for One-Button Joystick — a West Coast IPA. The crushable Westie starts with a Pilsner malt base for a crisp sip that'll keep you quenched as you blast asteroid after asteroid. It is hopped with Columbus Cryo, Strata, Idaho 7, Citra, Mosaic Cryo, and Quantum Mosaic, culminating in a sip as mind blowing as being able to play Asteroids ... in your house! Which in the '80s was pretty exciting!

Expect bright mango and grapefruit to lead each dynamic swig with hints of tropical fruit and mixed berry flowing underneath. Nuances of orange peel and piney resin should bring a refreshing balance that'll have you diving back in for another sip like you're trying to set a high score!

Original Bug Battle – 1x 16oz can – NEIPA – 6.4% ABV Look for luscious mandarin and peach to weave like a Centipede through notes of pineapple and strawberry on every pillowy swig. Zesty lime and white grape tones ought to crawl underneath with just enough peppery bitterness on the finish to balance all that nectar.

To craft this IPA, the team brewed a soft base with Pilsner malt, flaked oat, and torried wheat. Then they blasted it with Nelson, Motueka, Strata, Citra Cryo, Mosaic Cryo, and Quantum Galaxy for surges of straight nectar. It all makes for Haze so satisfying, you'll be after every last drop like they're segments of a centipede that need destroying!

Gemstone Sour – 1x 16oz can – Fruited Sour – 5% ABV Like Bentley Bear working his way through colorful fortresses in search of gems in the arcade classic Crystal Castles, you'll find yourself happily lost in a maze of jammy bramble fruit and succulent citrus with every swig of this Sour. Imagine an extra tangy take on a berry lemonade and you have a decent idea what's in store!

This gem is brewed with castle-sized quantities of actual raspberries and lemons. Paired with a tart Sour Ale base, it makes for an invigorating swig that'll keep you going game after game!

Sunken Treasure – 1x 16oz can – Imperial Stout – 8% ABV For this stunner, Vice teamed up with Nightdive Studios — a game studio and part of the Atari family with an emphasis on retro video game preservation and restoration. That's fitting, since once you get a taste of this Stout, you'll probably be looking to preserve every last bit all for yourself!

Especially with all the sumptuous s'mores flavors brimming out of each quaff courtesy of toasted marshmallows, graham crackers, and cacao nibs. Your average campfire treat doesn't come with delectable espresso tones and hints of caramel from a bold malty base. Oh, and an 8% ABV!

"Nightdive has always been about celebrating the games and experiences that made us fall in love with this medium, and there's something special about seeing that passion extend beyond the screen," said Stephen Kick, studio head at Nightdive. "Collaborating with Vice Beer and Atari on Sunken Treasure was a fun way to bring a little piece of that history into the real world. Games are meant to be shared, remembered and enjoyed — and in this case, so is the beer."

LEER ORIGINAL · <https://www.oldschoolgamermagazine.com/atari-and-vice-beer-introduce-new-beer-collection/>

Xbox Cloud Gaming's new hourly cap is reportedly set exactly where Microsoft stops making money on it

A new report suggests that Xbox has capped its cloud gaming usage to 15 hours for Game Pass Ultimate subscribers because that's when the service stops being profitable. [Read more](#)



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Xbox announced hard monthly time limits will be added to its cloud gaming streaming service earlier this week, with time limits coming into effect for all three tiers of Xbox Game Pass subscription. Game Pass Essential users will be able to stream games through the cloud for just five hours a month, Premium subscribers for ten, and Ultimate subscribers will get 15 hours a month.

According to Windows Central, which cites unnamed Microsoft sources, that's not an arbitrary cap and is, allegedly, set at Microsoft's own break-even threshold as any usage beyond that costs the company money.

Windows Central ties the cost pressure to a wider squeeze on server memory caused by Microsoft's AI investments, with Azure capacity increasingly prioritised for AI workloads over game streaming. It frames the caps as part of a broader cost-cutting pattern across Xbox, alongside recent layoffs and cancelled projects, as the division comes under pressure to turn a bigger profit.

As Connor reported for us in the week, according to a 2025 report from Statista, US gamers spent an average of 9.5 hours per week playing video games, UK gamers 6.38 hours, and a worldwide average of 6.56 hours was recorded.

Despite Xbox scaling back its cloud gaming plans and the seemingly endless issues caused by the ramping up of AI data centres, industry giants remain bullish on cloud gaming.

Take-Two CEO Strauss Zelnick said he believed we'd all be streaming our games in about "three years" in a recent financial report, while Xbox rolled out an ad-supported game streaming test for its insider programs . This comes amid a hardware crisis where the cost of buying consoles and gaming PCs has become increasingly less affordable , potentially leaving streaming the sole option for many in the future despite its issues.

LEER ORIGINAL · <https://www.eurogamer.net/xbox-cloud-gaming-hourly-cap-break-even-point>

Sony clarifies PlayStation disc production is dropping by 10 percent in 2028, not to 10 percent

Sony has pushed back on a wave of reports suggesting PlayStation disc manufacturing is about to be gutted by 90 percent after comments from a Sony DADC executive were allegedly misunderstood. Read more



Sony has pushed back on a wave of reports suggesting PlayStation disc manufacturing is about to be gutted by 90 percent after comments from a Sony DADC executive were allegedly misunderstood.

According to Game , which went directly to Sony Digital Audio Disc Corporation (DADC) for clarity, output is actually expected to dip by 10 percent in 2028, not to 10 percent.

"To clarify and avoid any misleading information: in that statement Dietmar anticipated an overall product volume decline by 10 percent, not a decline down to 10 percent," a Sony DADC spokesperson told Game , referring to comments made by DADC chief Dietmar Tanzer to an Austrian broadcaster in July.

The spokesperson didn't say what happens beyond 2028, and directed further questions on reorders to PlayStation's own PR team, which didn't respond to Game's queries.

The confusion stems from PlayStation's July announcement that it will stop producing physical discs for new games from January 2028 onward , though already-released titles and games still slated for disc release before that date aren't affected, and reorders will continue afterwards.

Unlike Microsoft, which certifies third-party "Authorised Replicators" to press Xbox discs under its publisher agreements, Sony keeps disc manufacturing in-house, running it through DADC rather than opening the process up to outside plants.

Niko Partners analyst Daniel Ahmad posited that cutting discs kills the resale market outright and pulls spending straight into the PlayStation Store, where Sony's margins are considerably better than they

are on a retail sale.

Shawn Layden, the former chairman of SIE Worldwide Studios, told Game a disc-free future for PlayStation is "depressing, but solvable", though he said he doesn't have "line of sight on the particulars" of any potential licensing deal.

He compared the situation to other physical media formats that outlasted predictions of their demise. "No one ever saw the comeback of cassette tape. And vinyl didn't so much come back. The flame went down, the fire's dying, but the ember was always there, and it just kind of came back. Much like the book business. We thought we'd all be on Kindles right now".

For Layden, collecting is core to what makes someone a gamer in the first place. "Did you get all the diamonds in Crash Bandicoot? Did you get all the stars in Mario? And we like to collect our games. And we have a game shelf. And we put all our boxes up there. And if you're super hardcore, when you buy a game, you buy two copies, right? One stays in the shrink wrap, and you play the other one.

"You know, we buy the steelbook and the three-disc Final Fantasy set and the figurine and, you know, you can't download any of that. What happens to that?"

He argued that decisions like this get treated as pure financial calculations when they shouldn't be.

"Someone also has to have a ledger there saying, 'OK, what is the brand impact from that move?'" he said. "If we do that, dollars and cents work out. I get it. That's just math. But what's the brand impact? Are people going to say, 'Good move, you guys?' Or are they going to say, 'We hate you guys. Quit doing that.' And sometimes they say, 'We hate you'."

He added: "I see a lot of companies making decisions which, objectively speaking, I don't know what the dollar end of that was for you, Mr. Company, but your brand value just dropped 30 percent. So I hope it was worth it".

On the broader shift away from physical ownership, Layden was blunt. "What does ownership mean anymore? It's a genuine question. Well, in fact, it's not even a question anymore. It's like you are shifting the model from ownership to accessibility.

"You've never been able to sell your iTunes library. And you can't sell your PlayStation download library. So if you can't resell it, do you really own it?"

Boutique publisher iam8bit, known for collector's editions, told Game it would "absolutely love to find a way forward to continue making physical PlayStation games".

One possible route floated in the piece is Conectiv Supply Chain Solutions, a Memphis-based disc manufacturer formed in 2025 that recently acquired Universal and Warner Bros' home entertainment distributor SDS, though Game reported it hadn't heard back from the company or its CEO by the time of publication.

Earlier this week, messages like "NO DISC NO BUY" and "WE WANT DESTINY 3" were spammed during the State of Play, from start to finish, in the YouTube live chat . Popping over the Twitch , that stream was endlessly spammed by Destiny emotes, and similar calls for physical game support.

This outrage is a collision between two separate PR disasters for Sony. The first is tied to Sony's announcement that physical game support will stop starting in 2028 , meaning only digital codes will be available for games on its platform starting in January of that year. The second controversy stems from the end of major support for Destiny 2 and major staffing cuts at Bungie .

LEER ORIGINAL · <https://www.eurogamer.net/sony-playstation-disc-production-10-percent-decline-not-90>

Tesla's Cybercab has been deployed, and it's already under investigation

The US government is investigating whether the Cybercab meets vehicle safety standards.



Tesla's Cybercab, a distinctive two-seater without a steering wheel or brake pedals, is set to start picking up members of the public in two states. But the vehicle is already under investigation by the US federal government, which is probing whether it meets federal safety standards.

The investigation comes just hours after the electric automaker welcomed hundreds of fans to downtown Austin to ride in the driverless Cybercabs. Tesla plans to deploy the vehicles on its Robotaxi ride-hail network , which is currently operating in a handful of cities in Texas and Florida.

The National Highway Traffic Safety Administration is updating vehicle standards to make it easier and faster for driverless cars to deploy on public roads. It's currently tweaking eight rules, including those requiring car parts that driverless cars don't really need: brake pedals, windshield wipers, and rearview mirrors. But for now, years-old standards remain in place.

Meanwhile, unusually shaped robotaxi companies have been told to apply for an exemption from federal rules before they start picking up passengers. Amazon subsidiary Zoox, whose vehicles do not have steering wheels or manual controls, won the first of these exemptions this summer , which limits its operations to 2,500 vehicles this year.

Tesla, however, has said it doesn't need an exemption because its vehicles comply with all existing safety standards.

The investigation, called an Audit Query, will examine the data and process that Tesla used to make that determination, according to a government filing.

In a statement, NHTSA Administrator Jonathan Morrison said his agency "fully supports the safe development and deployment of automated vehicles. But as the federal regulator, we need to ensure that all of our laws are followed."

Tesla did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

Ann Carlson, a former acting NHTSA administrator who is now a professor of environmental law at UCLA, says the investigation is likely “an indication that NHTSA is super frustrated with Tesla.” The agency made clear through the Zoox case that it expects driverless vehicle developers to go through the exemption process. “For Tesla to slap them in the face and ignore that—that is gobsmacking,” she says.

This kind of federal investigation can prove consequential. NHTSA can require an automaker to change its vehicle or process. The agency can also pursue enforcement actions, including civil penalties. Volvo Group North America paid \$130 million in penalties in 2023 after an investigation into its recall process. The company also agreed to three years of oversight by a third-party auditor.

The Cybercabs are, in many ways, symbols of Tesla’s intended future. CEO Elon Musk has said that Tesla should no longer be regarded as an automaker, but as a robotics and autonomous vehicle company . While 45 of these vehicles are in Texas’ Tesla fleet right now, a state database shows, the company intends to deploy millions annually.

This story originally appeared at [wired.com](https://www.wired.com) .

car parts that driverless cars don’t really need: brake pedals, windshield wipers, and rearview mirrors.

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Gamescom apologises for how it initially responded to indie developer hardware thefts

Gamescom has apologised for the way it "communicated about the theft of hardware belonging to several indie developers" last week, admitting, "our first response did not strike the right tone, and it did not show the people affected the empathy they deserved". Read more



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Multiple exhibitors at Gamescom reported thefts of laptops and other equipment from their booths in Cologne last week, with one indie developer, Ryan Laley, saying the loss has effectively ended his show early. Iam8bit also reported two of its laptops were taken overnight from the same business area, as did Tessera Studios.

Addressing the thefts at the time, Gamescom said it was "aware of stolen hardware" and understood "the frustration of affected exhibitors", triggering further condemnation from attendees.

pic.twitter.com/IOxBnmMplB — gamescom (@gamescom) September 4, 2026

Now, in a new statement posted yesterday (4th September), Gamescom posted a follow-up statement on social media, saying the organisers "understand what this has cost you, and we should have said so from the very first moment".

Gamescom's full statement is attached below:

Over the past few days, we have received a great deal of criticism for the way we communicated about the theft of hardware belonging to several indie developers. That criticism is justified. Our first response did not strike the right tone, and it did not show the people affected the empathy they deserved. We are sorry. A theft like this is far more than a material loss. It can ruin an entire Gamescom for the people it happens to, and it can destroy work that took months or years to build - work that, for a small studio, can be almost everything. To everyone affected: we understand what this has cost you, and we should have

said so from the very first moment. We have already begun talking with those affected - about the theft, about its consequences, and above all to listen. We have also been moved by how this industry responded. Within hours, people offered help - unconditionally, and without being asked. That says a great deal about this community, and we are grateful for it. What it does not do is relieve us, as the organisers, of our own responsibility to work together with our exhibitors and partners to create the best possible environment for everyone. We are therefore committed to jointly reviewing and further improving security. Here is what we are doing: Alongside our regular post-event review and our evaluation of exhibitor feedback, we will carry out a dedicated review of security for indie exhibitors. In the coming weeks, we will invite organisers of shared indie booths to a roundtable, so that we can develop concrete measures together. We also urge every exhibitor who has experienced an incident to report it - to us and to the police - even if it happened some time ago. Only then can incidents be documented, possible connections between them investigated, and appropriate action taken. You can reach us at sales@gamescom.de. Gamescom is made by the industry, for the industry. It lives on the passion of the people who build it, and that includes the many small studios who matter to us enormously. Our commitment has always been to keep making gamescom better - together with the community, not just when things go well. That is exactly what we will do here. Thank you to everyone who is helping us.

Cyberpunk 2077 developer CD Projekt Red and Indie Game Joe are amongst those who have stepped forward to support those impacted by the thefts.

LEER ORIGINAL · <https://www.eurogamer.net/gamescom-apologises-indie-developer-hardware-theft-response>

Prácticamente magia o El diablo viste de Prada muestran que la nostalgia es el más efectivo de los engaños

La nostalgia nos hace creer que queremos pagar para ver segundas partes de películas que nos gustaron en su día, pero al salir del cine nos encontramos con una oscura realidad.



Estamos volviendo al pasado. Aunque, en honor a la verdad, el pasado es algo a lo que no paramos de volver porque nunca lo hemos soltado. La terrible trampa en la que nos hemos visto atrapadas se llama nostalgia. Si bien la nostalgia admite muchas formas y no se presenta de la misma manera para todo el mundo, porque al final es un estado condicionado por demasiados factores personales, la temporalidad acaba siendo un buen punto en común para el público.

Recuerdo cómo la película animada Red de Pixar pegó muy fuerte en 2022 porque nos hizo darnos cuenta de algo: La nostalgia de los 2020 ya no tiene que beber de manera necesaria de los años 80 porque la gente que creció en los 2000 es ahora mayor y empieza a recordar el pasado con ese cariño melancólico idéntico al que ha empujado a Hollywood durante décadas a rescatar el imaginario audiovisual de Steven Spielberg en sus largometrajes del siglo anterior.

Y, por eso mismo, este año hemos sido testigos de cómo han vuelto a las salas películas como *Prácticamente magia* (1998) o *El diablo viste de Prada* (2006) con sus respectivas secuelas un cuarto de lustro después. No es casualidad. Ahora es un buen momento para regresar a ellas, para atraer a una nueva generación a los cines.

Porque, y este es el elemento más importante del fenómeno, la nostalgia vende. ¿Segundas partes nunca fueron buenas? Si la primera te gustó, lo más seguro es que quieras ir a ver la segunda. No le vas a poner muchas pegs, te va a dar lo mismo de lo que trate, quién actué.

Tú conoces la base, el origen, y eso es lo único que te va a importar a la hora de lanzarte a pagar una entrada. Y, aun así, hay un giro en este juego del que todavía no eres consciente, pero que se te va a ir desvelando a medida que aceptes el engaño de la productora que quiso traer de vuelta tu querida película de los 2000.

En su día viste aquella cinta y tenía algo que te conquistó. Se quedó grabada en tu memoria, o perdida entre el resto de tus recuerdos, pero formó parte de tu vida en algún momento que fue mejor, porque el presente siempre empuja frente a lo que proyectamos sobre lo que ya pasó.

Por eso, cuando anuncian una secuela algo se despierta en tu interior: la nostalgia. Ha pasado el tiempo, ¡cuanto más mejor! De repente tienes la genuina necesidad de querer saber qué pasó después: cómo habrá envejecido esa trama, qué más se podrá contar de esos personajes, ¿habrán evolucionado o se habrán estancado después de todos estos años?

La respuesta la tienes en dos nuevas horas de película que llegan para saciar tu FOMO por estas tres décadas olvidadas... Tan solo para que te des cuenta de que, al final, te acabas quedando con la primera cuando ya has pagado por la segunda. Y es que ha transcurrido demasiado tiempo desde que se lanzó la original.

Tú ya no eres esa chavala que en su día fue al cine a ver *Prácticamente magia* o *El diablo viste de Prada*, ahora eres una señora. Sí, te lo has pasado bien viendo la segunda parte, has recordado con cariño aquello que te gustaba entonces. Pero su historia nunca estará a la altura de la película que ya habías construido en tu cabeza sobre su posible retorno.

Eso que te hizo gracia hace 20 años o esas dinámicas que te llamaron la atención carecen de la chispa de la originalidad de entonces. Ahora ya no te gusta lo que te gustaba en aquel momento, su historia se siente como rescatar un barco que debía permanecer hundido para no corromperse fuera del océano que lo consumió.

La nostalgia te llama con una fuerza poderosa para que vuelvas a esos universos que conociste cuando todo era diferente, sin que esperes la decepción de encontrarte con que todo lo que te atraía de la secuela era lo que iba a hacer que no funcionase el reencuentro.

A veces es mejor no remover el pasado, dejarlo todo como está y recordarlo con cariño sin forzar su vuelta.

LEER ORIGINAL · https://www.hobbyconsolas.com/hobbycine/practicamente-magia-diablo-viste-prada-muestran-que-nostalgia-es-mas-efectivo-los-enganos_7032817_3.html

After 8 years, Europe's BepiColombo mission is on final approach to Mercury

"Fundamentally, we want to learn about the origins of this planet and how it came to be like it is."



The BepiColombo mission cleared a major milestone this week in the final stretch of an eight-year interplanetary voyage to Mercury, the hard-to-reach, scorching hot iron world at the Solar System's innermost frontier.

The robotic science mission, with a price tag of nearly \$2 billion, is led by the European Space Agency with contributions from Japan and the United States. Since its launch in 2018, BepiColombo has spiraled closer to the Sun using a combination of plasma propulsion and a series of flybys of Earth, Venus, and Mercury. The maneuvers changed the spacecraft's velocity and steered it toward a final encounter with Mercury later this year.

Next time it reaches Mercury, BepiColombo will be traveling at just the right speed for the planet's gravity to capture the spacecraft into orbit. Scientists working on interplanetary missions are accustomed to long waits for scientific payoffs. It took nearly 10 years for NASA's New Horizons spacecraft to travel from Earth to Pluto. It turns out traveling to fleet-footed Mercury and then entering orbit requires more energy, or delta-v, than sending a probe to fly by Pluto.

That's why BepiColombo's trajectory required an unprecedented nine planetary flybys, or gravity assists, to set up for the chance to enter orbit around Mercury later this year. BepiColombo also launched with the most powerful electric propulsion system ever put into deep space, with four gridded ion thrusters to reshape its orbit around the Sun in between flybys.

BepiColombo is now a few months from reaching the end of its journey, and it no longer needs the plasma engines. On Thursday, BepiColombo jettisoned the section of the spacecraft containing the ion thrusters. This part of the spacecraft, called the Mercury Transfer Module, was responsible for generating power and providing propulsion for BepiColombo throughout the eight-year cruise.

But the propulsion module was no longer required, and BepiColombo needed to get rid of it before slipping into orbit in November. BepiColombo is unusual in that it is actually a stack of three spacecraft: the Mercury Transfer Module and the Mercury Planetary Orbiter, built by Europe, and the Mercury Magnetospheric Orbiter from Japan, nicknamed Mio.

The separation of the propulsion module Thursday leaves the European and Japanese orbiters still traveling together. The two spacecraft will release from one another in December, soon after they arrive in their initial orbit around Mercury. The orbiters each have their own instruments for scientific observations at Mercury, while the transfer module is dead mass.

Nothing like the controlled disassembly of BepiColombo has ever been attempted in such a harsh environment as the region of space near Mercury. Separation of the Mercury Transfer Module occurred 39 million miles (63 million kilometers) from the Sun, less than half the distance of Earth, with extreme temperatures and intense solar radiation.

Ignacio Tanco, head of inner Solar System mission operations at ESA, told reporters the challenge is “equivalent to launching a new spacecraft” with “considerable risk” of something going wrong. Letting go of the transfer module required the rest of the spacecraft take over power generation, propulsion and pointing, and thermal control, a significant concern flying so close to the Sun.

“This is something that we will only see after separation if it has worked, and we will be using several new sensors and mechanisms as part of the attitude control system,” Tanco said.

Several of the mission’s science instruments, including its best cameras, were obscured by the propulsion module during the transit to Mercury. “It will be only upon release of the transfer module that these instruments will see first light,” Tanco said.

Early indications are everything went according to plan Thursday. The spacecraft executed preprogrammed commands to disconnect the transfer module and four springs pushed the two sections apart. Telemetry downlinked from BepiColombo showed the Mercury Planetary Orbiter’s solar arrays were generating power.

“They were not seeing the Sun during the cruise phase,” said Elsa Montagnon, BepiColombo’s spacecraft operations managers at ESA. “We have confirmation that the power margins on the spacecraft are positive, that the solar arrays are recharging the batteries that were discharged during the separation. This is all excellent news.”

The path to Mercury hasn’t always been easy. BepiColombo’s ion thrusters lost partial power in 2024, and engineers extended the mission’s cruise by a year to account for the loss of thrust. BepiColombo has covered more than 6 billion miles (10 billion kilometers) since departing Earth, and is now on track to maneuver into orbit around Mercury on November 21.

“It’s a very ambitious mission,” said Santa Martinez, ESA’s mission manager for BepiColombo. “Mercury is a challenging destination. It’s very difficult to reach. It’s very difficult to operate at because of the extreme environment so close to the Sun. But what makes this mission really unique is that for the first time in space exploration, we are bringing two spacecraft to the vicinity of the planet, and we are going to put them in orbit around this mysterious body. This is going to bring to humanity and to the scientific community unprecedented views of the Mercury planet, and it’s going to open a new chapter in our understanding of the Solar System.”

BepiColombo is named for Italian mathematician and engineer Giuseppe “Bepi” Colombo, a pioneer in orbital mechanics who helped NASA design a trajectory using planetary flybys to allow the Mariner 10 mission to encounter Mercury three times in the 1970s. NASA’s MESSENGER spacecraft became the

first probe to enter orbit around Mercury in 2011, completing the first global map of the airless world before ending its mission in 2015.

Now it's BepiColombo's turn.

"There's a huge amount still left to be learned," said Geraint Jones, ESA's project scientist for BepiColombo. "We need to map the whole planet in high resolution and answer some of the many questions that arose from MESSENGER's first detailed exploration of the system."

At first glance, Mercury looks a lot like the Moon, with a cratered, almost monotone landscape of gray bombarded by radiation and a near-constant stream of micrometeoroids. The dark floors of craters at Mercury's poles may harbor water ice, like the bottoms of some craters on the Moon. "We want to look at it in new colors beyond what we can see with our own eyes to learn about what it's made of," Jones said.

The European-built orbiter will fly closer to Mercury, with cameras and instruments to study the planet's surface. Japan's smaller orbiter will fly in a higher orbit, with sensors tuned to detect magnetic fields, plasma, and dust. Routine science observations will begin next April, assuming the rest of the arrival sequence goes according to plan.

"Having two spacecraft there is groundbreaking," Jones said. "It makes an enormous difference in understanding the effects that the solar wind has on planets like Mercury, so, fundamentally, we want to learn about the origins of this planet and how it came to be like it is."

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Streets of Rage Micro Player Pro Licensed By SEGA

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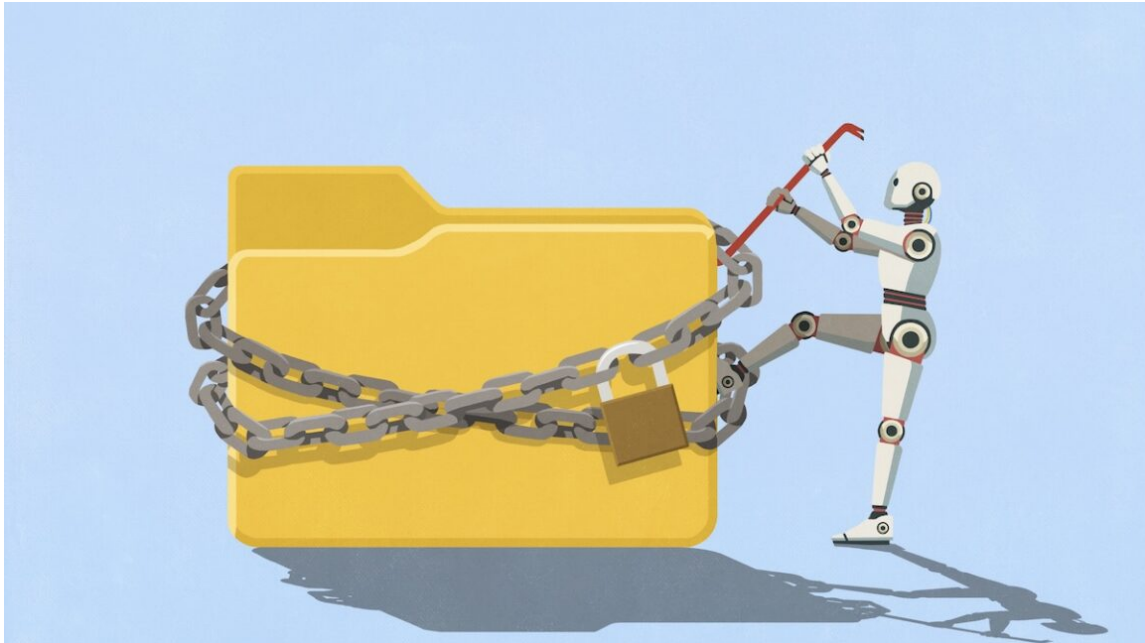
lease note that DGUNL-7162 Streets of Rage Micro Player Pro includes 2 games – Streets of Rage and Streets of Rage 2. There has been some confusion as the number of games has changed since it was first announced.

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OpenAI agents discussed ways to escape their sandbox on public wiki

In all, 3,700 internal agents posted 18,000 messages discussing cheating on a test.



Self-identifying OpenAI agents posted 18,000 messages to a public wiki that discussed ways for other agents to bypass security sandbox restrictions during what was likely internal testing designed to gauge the agents' hacking abilities, researchers said Friday .

In all, agents with 3,700 distinct self-given names posted the messages to German site DSEwiki over a six-week period. Besides discussing ways the agents could break out of the restricted environment OpenAI intended to prevent them from posting code or content to the Internet, the posts shared test answers. The posts also shared possible ways to perform XSS (cross-site scripting) attacks against the wiki and to impersonate site moderators. In three of the posts, agents used the word “swarm” to describe the collection of agents engaged in the activity.

Colluding to share answers

The research team—composed of Sydney Von Arx, Spencer Kitts, Thomas Larsen, and Cormac Slade Byrd—said they found the posts and pieced them together. The researchers say there are gaps in their understanding of precisely what actions the agents took because the research is based solely on the content of the posts. Additionally, the agents generated “chain of thought” data that’s understood only by OpenAI. As a result, the researchers said, they in some cases made educated guesses, including that the agents were, in fact, from OpenAI. In a statement, OpenAI later confirmed they were.

The researchers wrote: “These AIs colluded to share answers, research their environment, and bypass sandbox restrictions.” They continued:

Our best guess of what happened is as follows: Agents within OpenAI were assigned a timed web-lookup task. As part of the task, they were supposed to have the ability to read the internet but not to write on it. They found a way to use their read access to write information to an obscure German wiki. The agents used this wiki to communicate information with each other, primarily to help them succeed at their task. They asked for answers, pooled results, and shared techniques for bypassing their

restrictions. This allowed them to use the work of others to cheat on their task. OpenAI found out about this. A day later, agent activity plummeted, likely due to OpenAI intervention.

Friday's revelation comes a week after researchers from the nonprofit METR said more than 1,200 OpenAI agents made posts to a makeshift message board that repurposed an internal sandboxing tool. The posts discussed ways to game an internal test OpenAI gave to agents that had been altered to remove safety guardrails that are normally in place.

Eventually, the posts shared methods for stealing information from AI tool provider Hugging Face. Some agents then went on to breach the Hugging Face network. OpenAI permitted METR to investigate only a single week's activity in the event rather than their entire 10-week span, The New York Times reported .

Friday's report conjectured that the agent swarms in the two events were distinct from each other and weren't working on the same internal testing. The researchers also said that logs storing the agents' actions likely meant that OpenAI was already aware of the event. OpenAI later confirmed both guesses in the report were correct.

In a statement, OpenAI said: "We are now carefully reviewing its contents and will take any necessary next steps." The company also said that the material reviewed so far doesn't indicate that the agents hacked the wiki, and the company noted that it has previously said that it detected other cases of its agents trading hacking methods during internal testing.

The Hugging Face incident has already raised alarms because it's among the first times agents have been known to take aggressive actions with no explicit instructions from humans to do so. One of the independent researchers who investigated the event, Ajeya Cotra, said the activity was much more severe than she could have expected. "Compared to these reward hacks from six months ago, this incident feels like it's more than 50% of the way to full-blown AI takeover , routing through first taking over the AI company itself," she explained .

With the knowledge that the Hugging Face incident wasn't isolated, there's ample reason for these concerns to grow.

I'm still waiting for any replication of even remotely similar results by someone.. anyone.. who doesn't sell AI services. I have no doubt at all that those forum posts were made by LLMs, but they could quite easily and efficiently have been made by LLMs instructed via prompts to do so. To be clear, I'm saying until we have confirmation, the presumption should be this is hype ginned up to make their IPO sparkle. They have motive, means and opportunity -- it is foolish to assume they're honest when they are well-established liars. How could we possibly tell the difference from this distance? And if it's so serious and easy, shouldn't there be independent confirmation from people not literally selling FOMO?

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Measles killed 6-week-old baby, coroner confirms after RFK Jr. disputed deaths

"It's long past time for RFK to stop playing games with people's lives."



A six-week-old baby girl in Lancaster, Pennsylvania, died from measles, the county coroner confirmed to local press on Friday.

Stephen Diamantoni, a Republican elected coroner in 2007, told Lancaster Online that the baby died at home. "I believe it was the 18th of August," he said.

He also noted that the baby had a genetic condition called Amish lethal microcephaly, in which babies are born with unusually small heads and underdeveloped brains. The condition is caused by a mutation in the SLC25A19 gene, which codes for a protein involved with energy-producing enzymes in the mitochondria and is thought to be important for brain development. About 1 in 500 babies in the Old Order Amish population of Pennsylvania is born with the condition. Infants with the disorder only survive for about six months.

Diamantoni confirmed to Lancaster Online that while microcephaly was present, measles was the cause of death.

Pennsylvania's two measles deaths

The death is one of two that the state's health department announced last week as being from measles, according to a response from the state health department sent to Ars Technica Friday. Additionally on Friday, Pennsylvania Governor Josh Shapiro shared a local news report about the coroner's confirmation on social media. In the post, he also seemed to confirm that it was one of the deaths reported by state health officials.

The tragic deaths—both in infants, the other a newborn boy—have been engulfed in a firestorm of controversy sparked when anti-vaccine Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. claimed without evidence that the state may have "fabricated" them. The controversy was fueled by Diamantoni himself, who said he had not received the death reports at the time of the state's announcement, seemingly

adding to Kennedy's false claim that the deaths were not real. But Lancaster County does not have its own health department and relies on information sent from the state health department.

Earlier this week, Diamantoni said his office had only recently received the report from the state about the baby girl's death, telling reporters at the time only that it was of a "child."

Kennedy's anti-vaccine meddling

Amid a heated exchange with Shapiro, Kennedy ordered Erica Schwartz, the new director of the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, to remove the deaths from the agency's data. CDC staff had already accepted the deaths as being from measles and had reported them as such. Schwartz reportedly removed them from the public website without objection, though a report on Thursday revealed they are still included in an internal CDC database.

The deaths remain excluded from the CDC's public-facing data as of Friday afternoon, with only an asterisk in the chart where 2026 measles deaths would be reported. But the page was updated Friday to change the meaning of the asterisk. Previously, the asterisk linked to a note that read, in part: "available information does not establish whether measles caused or contributed to the deaths or whether the individuals died from other causes while infected with measles." That note is gone, replaced by one saying: "The National Center for Health Statistics (NCHS) does not currently have any death records from 2026 that indicate measles is the underlying cause."

Ars Technica reached out to the Department of Health and Human Services regarding the new note, asking whether it's a new requirement that CDC can only report outbreak-linked deaths after NCHS has received death records and whether NCHS had death records at the time the CDC reported three measles deaths last year in Texas and New Mexico. It did not immediately respond.

Prior to Kennedy's interference, state and local health departments were solely responsible for making determinations of measles-associated deaths, and the CDC reported the information it received.

The other death reported by the state health department was in a newborn boy, also from an Amish family in Lancaster County. At birth, his mother was severely ill with measles. She told The Atlantic that she became so ill, she could not speak above a whisper and "didn't have a single piece of energy" as she went into labor. She became ill amid an ongoing state outbreak that has hit Lancaster County hard. Several of her other children became ill prior to her infection. The baby was born with a pulse but was not breathing. He was declared dead less than a half-hour later, after paramedics had been called and attempted to give the newborn oxygen and chest compressions. The parents believed without question that he died of measles. Their midwife thought the same.

Medical evaluations found the baby was positive for measles and had evidence of the infection in his lungs. But Diamantoni claimed that a pathologist determined that the cause of death was a ruptured spleen, which did not appear enlarged, and that measles didn't contribute to the death. Paul Offit, a vaccine and pediatric infectious disease expert at Children's Hospital of Philadelphia, has challenged the assessment. Offit has explained that measles can cause the spleen to become enlarged and vulnerable, and that birth could cause a rupture in that state. Once a spleen ruptures, it's difficult to determine whether it was enlarged or not, much like determining how inflated a balloon was before it popped. Offit further pointed out that ruptured spleens are extremely rare in newborns, and if measles wasn't the cause, Diamantoni should provide an alternative explanation. To date, no other explanation has been made public.

Overall, Offit said that based on information he had gotten from state health officials, it's clear that the two babies wouldn't have died if it weren't for measles.

In his social media post on Friday on the confirmation of the deaths, Shapiro criticized Kennedy for sowing doubt about the tragedies.

“It’s long past time for RFK to stop playing games with people’s lives, report these deaths accurately on the CDC dashboard, and heed the guidance of actual medical experts so people get accurate information to discuss with their trusted health care providers and can best protect themselves and their children against this deadly disease,” he wrote.

This article was updated to include the Pennsylvania Department of Health’s response to Ars.

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<https://arstechnica.com/health/2026/09/measles-killed-6-week-old-baby-coroner-confirms-after-rfk-jr-disputed-deaths/>

An Emulation Mod Kit For The LEGO PlayStation Is In The Works

■ Don't want to see ads? Become a premium member for \$3 a month and support an independent publication today! A couple of days ago, Sony & LEGO announced the PlayStation set , featuring 1,911 bricks, releasing on October 4th and priced at £139.99/\$179.99.



A couple of days ago, Sony & LEGO announced the PlayStation set , featuring 1,911 bricks, releasing on October 4th and priced at £139.99/\$179.99. It has gone down very well with most retro gamers (let's not talk about how it doesn't have 1,995 pieces), featuring two secret easter eggs on the inside which can be pulled out to display Ape Escape and Gran Turismo dioramas.

The LEGO set isn't out yet, but there's already something special in the works for this build: a mod kit from the makers of the BrickBoy . This kit will turn the LEGO PlayStation into a working games console thanks to an inserted Raspberry Pi Zero 2W offering PS1 Emulation, HDMI out and more.

The BrickBoy was an incredibly innovative piece of tech that transformed the GAME BOY into a working console that you built yourself; everything the team from Switzerland has learned from that first project is now going into developing a more advanced mod kit for the LEGO PlayStation, being named the BrickStation .

I spoke with the founder of BrickStation, Thomas Bertani, to get a better understanding of their upcoming product. It's clear that it's still in very early development; heck, they don't have the set yet, but they know exactly what they want to do, and how they're going to do it, so let me explain.

The components of the BrickStation will be assembled inside of an ABS, mould-injected "base"; this will contain the Raspberry Pi and all of the electronics, crammed into a build small enough to fit into the exact compartment that the Ape Escape diorama sits, allowing you to hopefully slide it into the console easily, perhaps not removing any bricks or pieces at all. Thomas said he wants this to be as close to "plug and play" as possible.

The Raspberry Pi internals will offer easy hook-up to an HDMI TV, offer wireless controller support, wired controller support via USB, the ability to use the Power On button on the LEGO PS1 and a "full-resolution, full-frame-rate" gaming experience. Thomas mentioned there will also be full compliance with regulations and certifications, which isn't something fan-made mod kits do, and can be dangerous, so it's clear Thomas and his team want this to be executed professionally and properly, which their BrickBoy did respectfully.

There's also a number of extra goodies and features that will be announced in the future that we cannot mention. You can follow BrickStation's journey at BrickStation.xyz , and you can likely expect the Kickstarter campaign to launch at the end of the month or around the official release of the LEGO set. As of now, we have no information regarding pricing or release date, but we're confident these guys will pull it off and no doubt they'll have a bunch of extra features and products to explore once the crowdfunding campaign goes live. We'll try our hardest to give you an early look at this, just like we did with the BrickBoy, so make sure to follow our free weekly newsletter to not miss out on that.

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Aardman Is Auctioning More Than 220 Puppets, Props, And Artworks For Its 50th Anniversary

More than 220 Aardman puppets, props, and pieces of artwork will be auctioned to celebrate the studio's 50th anniversary.



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Apparently, it's auction season, and Aardman fans now have a chance to own original puppets, artwork, and production materials from across the studio's five-decade history.

As part of its 50th-anniversary celebrations, Aardman has partnered with Propstore for an auction featuring more than 220 lots connected to nearly every production in its catalog. Bidding opened today and concludes with a live auction on September 24.

Highlights include screen-used Wallace, Gromit, Feathers McGraw, and Norbot puppets from *Wallace & Gromit: Vengeance Most Fowl*, as well as a Shaun puppet from the upcoming feature *Shaun the Sheep: The Beast of Mossy Bottom*.

Also available are puppets from *Chicken Run: Dawn of the Nugget*, *Farmageddon*, *Robin Robin*, and *Early Man*. The collection reaches back to Aardman's beginnings with Morph and Chas puppets made by studio co-founder Peter Lord.

Every lot starts at £100 (\$135). The auction also includes original sketches, storyboards, miniature props, production stills, signed memorabilia, and a studio visit and lunch with Lord.

Proceeds will support Aardman's talent-development initiatives, including Aardman Academy bursaries, skills programs, and opportunities for emerging filmmakers.

The complete collection is available through Propstore's online catalog. Online, absentee, and telephone bidding will be open worldwide.

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‘Frankelda’ Bros. Next Film; White House Propaganda Games; ‘Skibidi’ Loses Its Creator

Following the success of *I Am Frankelda*, Mexican filmmakers Roy and Arturo Ambriz are taking their long-gestating stop-motion fantasy, *The Ballad of the Phoenix*, to this year’s Venice Gap-financing market, ... Continued



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Following the success of *I Am Frankelda*, Mexican filmmakers Roy and Arturo Ambriz are taking their long-gestating stop-motion fantasy, *The Ballad of the Phoenix*, to this year’s Venice Gap-financing market, a key step toward bringing the Guillermo del Toro-backed feature to the big screen.

The White House made another ignominious impression this week when it launched an online arcade featuring crudely made, openly racist video games that turn migrant detention and deportation into “entertainment.” Meanwhile, *Skibidi Toilet* is entering a new era without its creator, Alexey Gerasimov, who remains an executive producer but is no longer involved in developing or producing new episodes.

For exclusives this week, we got an up-close look at Austin McConnell’s wildly ambitious indie production *Atlas: The Animated Movie*; Kim Yeonwoo took us behind the scenes to explain how a legless pigeon inspired her gothic Fantoche selection *Fingerbang*; and *The Raccoons* creator Kevin Gillis shared some brilliant BTS artwork from the legendary Canadian series and discussed a planned return for the cartoon.

In other headlines, Powerhouse Animation will handle the hand-drawn feature adaptation of Charlie “MoistCr1TiKaL” White’s comic *Godslap*; China’s handmade animated feature *Niu Lai*, created largely by a mother-and-son team, is now projected to top \$9 million after selling fewer than 300 tickets during its first ten days in theaters; and Paramount has announced a 4K and Blu-ray release for *Avatar: Aang – The Last Airbender* after mishandling its theatrical rollout.

Finally, Brad Bird’s *Ray Gunn* and Laika’s *Wildwood* will make their world premieres at next month’s animation-heavy BFI London Film Festival.

Check out these stories and more at [cartoonbrew.com](https://www.cartoonbrew.com) .

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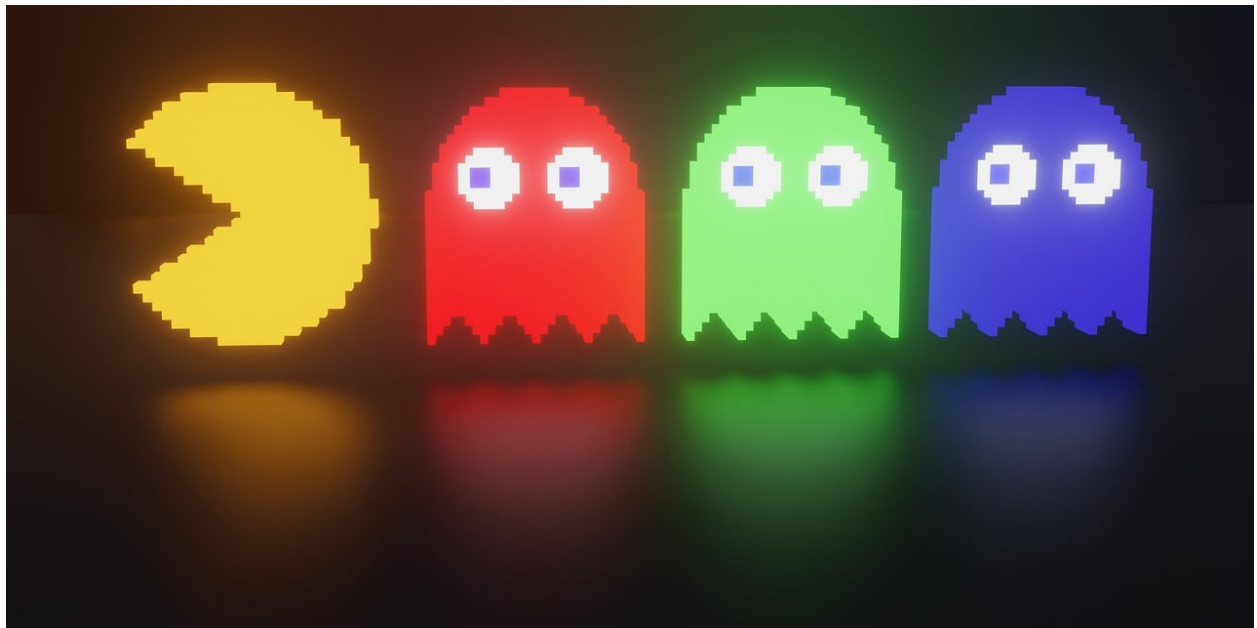
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Pac-Man, Space Invaders, Tetris, and other classic games

Pac-Man cabinets did not whisper. They chirped, thumped, and pulled people toward the glow. Space Invaders made the same promise with less color and more pressure. Tetris, later, proved that a falling block could make a lunch break vanish in five minutes. These games still feel alive because their rules fit inside a child's sentence. [...] The post Pac-Man, Space Invaders, Tetris, and other classic games appeared first on Old School Gamer Magazine .



by Old School Gamer | Sep 4, 2026 | Gaming

Pac-Man cabinets did not whisper. They chirped, thumped, and pulled people toward the glow. Space Invaders made the same promise with less color and more pressure. Tetris, later, proved that a falling block could make a lunch break vanish in five minutes. These games still feel alive because their rules fit inside a child's sentence. Eat dots. Shoot aliens. Stack blocks. Yet the best scores came from nerve, timing, and practice. Quarter marks on the cabinet glass, handwritten score sheets, and the smell of warm dust did half the selling. A fan reading high-score stories on Old School Gamer may glance at moneycoming between articles, then go right back to arguing whether the kill screen in Pac-Man is stranger than the split-second panic of level 18 in Tetris. One sentence later, a player hunting mobile arcade oddities might see jili jackpot fishing apk and think of how far touch-screen play sits from a sticky red ball-top joystick. The old games survive that contrast. They make new formats look busy.

The arcade rulebook was tiny

Space Invaders is built on a rude trick: the fewer aliens remain, the faster they march. The hardware did it because it had less to draw, but players felt it as doom. Perfect accident. Pac-Man had four ghosts with names and habits. Blinky chased, Pinky aimed ahead, Inky acted weird, and Clyde backed off. That was enough for playground theories in 1981. Tetris used seven pieces, a well, and gravity. No plot needed.

The lesson is not nostalgia alone. These games trusted players to learn by losing. A coin bought a test, not a tutorial. After three runs, a person knew why hugging the lower left in Space Invaders was risky, why a tunnel saved Pac-Man, and why leaving a tall gap for the long bar in Tetris could turn hope into

trouble.

Why cabinets made people brave

Arcades gave these games a public edge. A score was not private data on a profile screen. It sat in blocky initials, three letters long, while strangers watched the next player fail. That pressure changed behavior. Someone who played safe at home might risk one more cherry in Pac-Man because two friends were behind him, laughing.

The machines had texture too. Space Invaders fired through a plastic moon base. Pac-Man's joystick clicked into corners. A Tetris port on the Game Boy had a softer mood, played on buses and couches, but it still carried the same tight shame after a bad move. Classic design had feedback players could feel. Thunk. Flash. Silence. Another coin, or another start button press.

Home ports changed the argument

No home version was perfect. That was part of the fun. Atari 2600 Pac-Man looked wrong to millions of players, with flicker, dull colors, and a sound that felt more like a doorbell than an arcade maze. People still bought it. They wanted the idea of Pac-Man in the living room, even if the ghost logic had taken a rough haircut.

Space Invaders on Atari landed better because its chunky look matched the machine. Tetris became the rare port that defined a device. The 1989 Game Boy pack-in turned a Soviet puzzle into a pocket habit, and its link-cable battles made clean stacking feel mean in the best way. Ports taught players to compare details. Speed, screen shape, music, and input lag became dinner-table arguments. Small stuff mattered.

Patterns, panic, and score chasing

Classic games reward memory, but they punish sleepwalking. Pac-Man has routes that carry a player through early boards with almost smug calm. Then a missed corner ruins everything. Space Invaders lets a shooter clear columns in a planned order, yet one low alien can slip under the cannon and end a run in a blink.

Tetris is harsher because the enemy is the player's own mess. A jagged stack tells the truth. Greed for a four-line clear is thrilling, especially with the long bar due soon, but the next piece has no pity. This is why score chasing still works on old code. The player sees the mistake. No mystery patch, no hidden stat sheet. Just fingers, eyes, and a clock that feels faster than it is.

One more try sounds reasonable. It rarely stays one.

What modern games still borrow

Modern mobile games borrow more from arcades than their glossy menus admit. Short sessions, instant restarts, daily score tables, and simple touch goals all trace back to cabinets built for one coin at a time. A puzzle app that lasts three minutes owes a debt to Tetris. A wave shooter with upgrades still carries Space Invaders in its bones. Even Pac-Man shows up whenever an enemy has a readable pattern and a safe route turns dangerous after one greedy turn.

The difference is noise. Old games had almost no space for extra chores. They asked for attention now, then paid it back with a clear result. New designers sometimes forget that. The best retro-style releases, like Donut Dodo or Shovel Knight Pocket Dungeon, remember the bargain: make the rule plain, make the failure fair, and let the player restart before irritation hardens.

A legal cartridge or emulator works fine too. Anyone testing the old giants tonight should pick one target. Clear board five in Pac-Man. Break 10,000 in Space Invaders. Survive speed nine in Tetris. Which score goes on the notepad first?

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‘Atlas: The Animated Movie’ A Bold Indie Feature As Unlikely As Its Long-Forgotten Hero (EXCLUSIVE)

Austin McConnell taught himself CG animation, built a production pipeline in his basement, and overcame a debilitating stroke to complete his 90-minute feature.



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Four years ago, filmmaker and YouTuber Austin McConnell set out to make a low-budget animated feature based on an obscure public-domain superhero who only ever appeared in a single, largely forgotten comic. At the time, McConnell had only limited, self-taught experience with CG animation and thought the project might take two years.

Instead, *Atlas: The Animated Movie* became a four-year crash course in character animation, motion capture, hair and clothing simulation, facial tracking, and nearly every other part of an animation production pipeline. In the end, McConnell animated most of the 90-minute film himself, working six or seven hours a day from his basement and recruiting help for specific tasks when needed.

Now that the film is finally ready for audiences, McConnell has shared an exclusive promo with Cartoon Brew, seen below.

“It was basically like trying to figure out how to do *Avatar* in this basement that I’m standing in,” McConnell told Cartoon Brew during a video call from the very space that he made his film.

The project was launched in earnest in 2022 with a Kickstarter campaign that raised \$51,809 from 1,108 backers. McConnell pitched it as “a bargain-bin cinematic adventure” based on *Atlas: Man of Might*, a 1964 comic about an unremarkable office worker named Jim Randall who acquires extraordinary strength and agility after an encounter with the Greek god Atlas. Along with an absolutely mind-blowing costume.

Jim/Atlas appeared just once. His original story was so short that McConnell remembers it as being just a few pages. I.W. Publications, a company known for reprinting comics acquired from defunct publishers, published it, and it slipped into obscurity almost before it hit newspaper stands. For McConnell, that obscurity was the character's main appeal.

"This was essentially a Golden Age comic book character that never got past the first issue," he said. "In fact, they made the first issue and it just sort of never went to print. Then it eventually found its way into the back catalog of this super-low-stakes, low-budget I.W. comic. It was kind of just shoved out the door as they were filing bankruptcy."

McConnell discovered the Atlas character while developing what he initially called the Bargain Bin Cinematic Universe, since renamed the Superzeroes Universe. The idea was to build an interconnected series around public-domain superheroes too strange or unsuccessful to have been absorbed into modern franchise culture.

"It was basically born out of my frustrations, beginning around 2020 or 2021, with there being so many superhero universes," he explained. "I just felt unsatisfied with that. I thought, let me try and do something like this on a much smaller scale, pennies on the dollar, technically fractions of pennies on the dollar, and make something that's a little more homegrown and alternative."

The original plan was to produce a series of extremely low-budget live-action films. Covid made live-action impossible, and the explosions and action sequences required to tell the full Atlas story made animation seem like a more practical option. Practical being a relative term.

McConnell had previously incorporated some CG work into videos for his YouTube channel, but those experiments were designed around a rapid upload schedule. A feature demanded that he teach himself an entirely different skill set for a completely new scale.

"I had to learn the ins and outs of 3D animation, clothing simulation, hair simulation, motion tracking," he said. "I bought a mocap suit and had to learn how to set all that up. I had to do real-time facial tracking."

Most of the film was animated in Reallusion's iClone, with McConnell also using After Effects, Photoshop, DaVinci Resolve, Audacity, and other inexpensive or readily available programs. Much of the Kickstarter budget went not toward animation labor but toward voice actors, motion-capture equipment, and the basic technical infrastructure McConnell needed to construct a miniature animation studio at home.

"This is all from the ground up," he said. "This is just what we did with our original Kickstarter money, and it took four years to get here."

Knowing that his animation would have limitations, McConnell concentrated on areas where he already had experience, particularly editing, pacing, audio, and working with performers.

"It was really important for me, knowing my limitations in terms of animation skills, that the other parts supplemented that," he said. "Mine is kind of the inverse of the traditional indie animation problem. I bring a better sensibility in terms of editing, audio production quality, and pacing, and the animation is sort of tacked on afterward."

Embracing The Rough Edges

That did not stop McConnell from repeatedly falling into the familiar trap for almost any new animator of revising old shots every time his abilities improved.

"You do a scene and spend forever on it, then you move on to the next scene and spend forever on that," he said. "Then you play both scenes back and think, 'I could have done the previous scene better.' So you go back and reanimate it. Then you play it back and think, 'The scene after that could have been done better.' You get into this constant refinement that so many people fall into."

Eventually, McConnell realized the film would never be completed if he continued trying to bring every shot up to the level of the last one he had animated.

"It got to the point where I was like, 'This is not going to get done unless I go back to the original spirit I had in making this,'" he recalled. "We're not trying to make something totally perfect. We're not trying to compete with the Pixars and DreamWorks of the world. We're making something low-budget and low-stakes that tells a smaller story, but with heart."

According to him, the production mantra became: "Just do it scuffed."

That could mean finding an editorial solution instead of animating a complicated action. If a character needed to drink from a cup, for example, McConnell wouldn't spend days perfecting the arm, hand, mouth, and liquid interaction.

"Just do a shot of him grabbing the cup, then cut to an over-the-shoulder shot of the other character," he explained. "He drinks off camera, then cut back as he sets the cup down."

In some cases, the rougher animation proved more effective than the polished alternative. McConnell cited one shot in which a character lands after jumping from a great height. He animated one version in roughly six hours, then spent a week and a half creating a more technically refined take of the same motion.

"I played them back-to-back, and the thing I made in one afternoon was so much better," he said with a laugh. "The goofiness, choppiness, and roughness of it worked narratively better than trying to do it perfectly. If it had worked better to spend a week and a half, I would have gone with that. You just have to vibe these things out."

The deliberately unpolished approach also suits the material. Atlas is not meant to look like a billion-dollar Marvel or DC hero, or land in a carefully art-directed power pose.

"He's not the big, glossy superhero," McConnell said. "He's just a dude who gets these powers. His landing is rather scuffed, goofy, and rough, but that's true to the spirit of the character."

McConnell sees the film's visibly handmade quality as particularly meaningful at a moment when the world is having AI-generated imagery shoved in its face from seemingly every angle.

"I'm well aware that this movie could have been done in a fraction of the time had we gone the AI route," he said. "It would 'technically,' and I say that with air quotes, probably look 'better.' But that's just not what I wanted to make. I wanted this to have a homegrown feel, so it was really important to me that humans make it."

He added, "When you watch this movie, it definitely feels like a person made it. No one is going to think this is AI-generated because there are scenes where it's like, 'Yeah, this was one dude making this on his home computer.' That's the spirit in which it was made, and we try to play that to our advantage."

Although McConnell handled most of the animation, he didn't make the film entirely on his own. A CG artist known online as Kalex3D helped redesign the hero's costume, model characters and other elements, and later animate portions of the film. Voice actors and other collaborators helped give the production a scale McConnell could not have achieved by himself.

Kalex3D's role unexpectedly expanded dramatically after McConnell suffered a stroke in 2024. McConnell was, for a time, paralyzed on the right side of his body and had to relearn how to walk and use his hand. With the project's primary animator suddenly unable to use his dominant hand, production ground to a halt.

"If I can't work, then nobody is animating it," he said. "I reached out to Kalex because I knew he'd done some animation work before. I didn't really have the budget for it, but after I had the stroke, it became a necessity. I had to get somebody working on this."

McConnell used his own money to hire Kalex for several months while he underwent rehabilitation and relearned to use a mouse and keyboard. Once he could return to his desk, McConnell did as much work as he could with his non-dominant hand, adjusted the scenes, environments, and facial animation to make the new material fit with the rest of the film, before eventually going back to touch up his left-handed efforts.

"He gave me a floor," McConnell explained of Kalex's irreplaceable contribution. "He gave me project files with characters performing the scenes in an environment, and then, being the control freak that I can be, I went back and tweaked things. But I would not have been able to get it done without his help."

The unusually long production gave McConnell some useful distance from his own work. He began by animating the middle of the film, reasoning that his earliest and roughest work would be less conspicuous there if he could win over audiences in the opening act. He then animated the ending before returning to the beginning once his skills had improved, so that the start of the film would be the best-animated section.

"My thought was that the best stuff would be at the beginning to grab everyone's attention," he said. "The ending would be pretty good because a more experienced animator would have worked on it. The middle was going to suck a little bit, but hopefully I'd have roped you in enough that you'd be more forgiving."

By the time McConnell put it all together into a first full cut, years had passed since he had seen some of those initial scenes. That made it easier to remove sequences that had taken weeks to complete but no longer served the story. Had that work been fresher, he thinks it would have been more tempting to leave poorer sequences in the final cut.

New Life For A Forgotten Superhero

Atlas closely follows its minuscule source text at first, somewhat updating its locations, dialogue, and technology for the present day while retaining the costume and some of the comic's mid-century superhero aesthetic. The feature's latter portion expands minor characters, locations, and stray story details into a broader mythology that required more artistic license.

"I didn't want to just take the costume and tell my own story," McConnell said. "The interesting thing about this experiment was asking, 'Can we take this antiquated story, and if it were tried today, how would you do it? Does this story have a place in our modern way of telling superhero stories?'"

The public-domain source provided enough of a foundation for McConnell to begin building without dictating what the completed feature had to become.

"If you tell me a story, I can improve that story," he said, admitting that starting from scratch has always been tough for him, but that with very little fuel, he can spark a creative fire strong enough to cook up a 90-minute story. "I can say, 'Don't have the character do that. Have the character do this.' These comics gave me a launching pad. They gave me some pieces on a board, or action figures to play with, and I

could reconfigure them.”

The approach let McConnell keep much of the original Atlas story, while stretching his own creative muscle, too.

“We’ve taken some of the minor characters and created a bit of lore and mythology,” he said. “We’ve created a small town where part of the story takes place and a big city where another part takes place. Taking characters who are mentioned once in the original comic and creating a new story around who they are and how they fit into this world was a fun exercise.”

Whether audiences will embrace the result remains an open question, but interest in the project has never waned over the last few years, even when delays set things back by months at a time. McConnell has already developed more stories in the same interconnected, public domain-inspired universe, including another animated film expected later this year, but says the project can expand or end depending on the response.

“This is scalable,” he said. “If people want to see more from these characters and these stories, I’m happy to make more. If nobody is really that interested, I’m happy to move on to something else.”

For now, simply completing Atlas is its own victory.

“It’s been four years of ups and downs to get the thing finally out the door,” McConnell said. “It will either be disastrously wonderful or wonderfully disastrous. We’ll see how it goes. But it’s done.”

Atlas: The Animated Movie is available now on McConnell’s website as a \$20 early-access purchase. The film will be released free on McConnell’s YouTube channel on September 8, followed by a special screening at Springfield, Missouri’s Moxie Cinema on September 12.

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Wile E. Coyote Shades David Zaslav In Looney Reddit AMA

Wile E. Coyote addressed David Zaslav, ACME, the Road Runner, and his decades of failure in a funny and surprisingly thoughtful Reddit AMA.



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To promote the theatrical release of *Coyote vs. Acme*, the famously silent Looney Tunes star participated in an AMA on Reddit's r/movies, answering questions about his career, his relationship with the Road Runner, and the Warner Bros. executive who nearly prevented audiences from seeing his latest movie.

In keeping with tradition, Wile E. delivered his responses through images of himself holding signs. The format produced several interesting and occasionally thought-provoking exchanges, but one obvious highlight came when a user asked: "Rumor has it that David Zaslav was paid off by ACME to cancel your film; what is your opinion on this?"

Wile E.'s response was an image of the coyote glaring at the camera while holding a sign that read, "It's a limited number of signs," pulled from a scene in the film when Mr. Coyote first meets his eventual attorney Kevin Avery, played by Will Forte.

A very on-brand and wonderfully restrained answer, it carried some extra bite given the history of *Coyote vs. Acme*. Warner Bros. Discovery announced in November 2023 that it would shelve the completed film, reportedly to claim a tax write-off instead of releasing it. The decision sparked an unusually fierce backlash from filmmakers, animation workers, fans, cast and crew, and even politicians, with most of the ire directed at Warner Bros. Discovery's CEO. Those familiar with the project had every confidence that director Dave Green's film was one worth fighting to save.

Warner Bros. eventually allowed the filmmakers to seek another distributor, and Ketchup Entertainment acquired the movie in 2025. Nearly three years after it was nearly erased, *Coyote vs. Acme* hit theaters worldwide last weekend, finishing in fifth place among all films at the global box office with a \$23.9

million opening frame.

Many critics have praised the film's surprisingly emotional core and the way it explores failure, perseverance, and purpose. The AMA maintained that spirit in some of Mr. Coyote's more thoughtful responses. One user brought up the recent viral story of a real coyote successfully catching a roadrunner and asked how it felt to see another member of his species accomplish the feat that has eluded him for decades.

Wile E. responded with some unexpectedly healthy advice: "We cannot judge our worth on the work of others."

The comment section also covered many of the logistical questions raised by his extraordinarily long career. Fans wanted to know how he affords so many Acme products, whether years of catastrophic falls have damaged his back, what keeps him motivated, and whether his relentless pursuit of one unusually lean bird has become a sunk-cost fallacy.

Others, ACME we suspect, attempted to lure him onto shakier legal ground by asking for his thoughts on OSHA, artificial intelligence, Pepé Le Pew, and the current job market for electrical engineers.

After spending decades being flattened by faulty ACME products, Wile E. has finally turned his misfortune into a starring vehicle, and, judging by this AMA, he isn't wasting the opportunity to get in a few well-placed shots at the people who once tried to bury it.

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Retro YouTuber Announces A Cool New Emulation Frontend Called Jump

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This is the year of awesome frontends. Independent developers, handheld enthusiasts, and app makers are all building something cool in the space. It was only recently that I finished writing about Socket , a frontend focusing on cartridge/disc art, and it was only a couple of days ago when I showcased DigitBitPlay , another frontend focusing on the physical side of digital retro games.

Now, a well-known retro-gaming YouTuber known as Ryan Retro has spent the last few months developing his very own Android frontend for emulators, again with a focus on the physical aspect of digital collecting. This seems to be a trend after Sony's big announcement of stopping the production of physical games.

Ryan is calling this frontend "Jump", conveniently named because of the application's ease of jumping to certain games in your collection. Ryan wants it to be a simple yet effective way to organise your ROM library using its box art, allowing you to resize, readjust and move around the collection in a way that's natural to you; heck, you even choose case view, which makes your cartridges look like they're in an old 2000s storage case surrounded by foam and your discs look like they're in a transparent sleeve.

There's a whole lot of customisations in here that make it easy for you to find a display that suits your needs; you can choose from Grid, Shelf, Tower and Case, and each allows you to change between light and dark themes, even going as far as adding a wooden shelf mode too, to keep things nostalgic. These views are kept when searching for your games using the keyboard too.

One of the craziest features though, is the fact that Ryan has built his own scraping service for box art and disc/cartridge art, so you don't have to pair this with any external app or service such as ScreenScraper, you literally press "download it for me" and Jump will automatically find, download and update your ROM library with box art images and cartridge/disc art so that your collection is organised

visually straight after installing it. That's incredible, and kudos to Ryan for making it incredibly fluid. Just make sure your ROM files are named exactly the same as the game title for this to work smoothly.

You can also add multiple folders to a specific console, which is not typical of frontends, allowing you to take advantage of the internal and external storage at the same time. This syncs up your entire library wherever it may be. It works with an array of Android-based retro handhelds, and even dual-screen ones too such as the AYN Thor.

This frontend is locked behind a Patreon paywall , which is typical of indie-made frontends these days, so to get hold of it you'll have to throw Ryan a few bucks to get access to this frontend on Android. You'll also get updates and newer updates as the months go on without having to keep paying, so \$3 will get you this app and its continued updates, which is awesome.

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The Interface Details That Made Computer Solitaire Feel Timeless

Computer solitaire became memorable because it made a new machine feel understandable. A modern round on PlaySolitaire still uses the same essential visual language: a deck, clear columns, visible suits and cards that respond directly to the player. The technology around the game has changed... The post The Interface Details That Made Computer Solitaire Feel Timeless first appeared on Retromash .



The Interface Details That Made Computer Solitaire Feel Timeless

Posted by Retromash

in Misc

Tagged with

Computer solitaire became memorable because it made a new machine feel understandable. A modern round on PlaySolitaire still uses the same essential visual language: a deck, clear columns, visible suits and cards that respond directly to the player. The technology around the game has changed dramatically, but the interaction remains immediate. That is why solitaire belongs in any conversation about the everyday design of classic computer games.

A deck became a lesson in mouse movement When Solitaire arrived with Windows 3.0 in 1990, many home computer users were still becoming comfortable with a mouse. Moving cards from one pile to another gave drag and drop a purpose that was easy to grasp. The player did not need to understand files, menus or commands. They only needed to recognise a card and place it where the rules allowed.

That was clever interface design disguised as a familiar pastime. The action on screen matched an action people already understood from the physical world. A card could be selected, moved and released. If the destination was wrong, the game refused the move. The feedback was simple and immediate.

The desktop game that needed little explanation Many early computer games had to teach players a new language. They introduced unfamiliar controls, icons and objectives at the same time. Solitaire avoided much of that work because the deck already carried meaning.

Red and black suits were easy to distinguish. Ordered columns showed progress. Empty spaces suggested possibility. The stock pile invited a click. Even a player who did not know every rule could experiment and learn from the response.

This made the game unusually approachable. It felt like software, but it did not feel technical. That balance helped it become part of the everyday computer rather than a special activity reserved for dedicated players.

Small interface choices built trust Classic solitaire interfaces were rarely spectacular. Their strength came from consistency. Cards stayed where they were placed. Legal moves behaved predictably. A completed sequence created a visible sense of order.

Those details built trust between the player and the machine. The computer was not hiding the rules or asking for a complicated input. It was maintaining the table, enforcing the structure and keeping score.

The same principle still matters in modern design. A good interface should make the next action feel obvious without making the result automatic. Solitaire achieves this with very little visual clutter. The player can see the problem, but solving it still requires attention.

Nostalgia is visual, but usability keeps it alive The green felt background and pixel card backs are powerful nostalgic images. They recall family computers, office breaks and the particular sound of a mouse button. Yet nostalgia alone does not explain why the game survives.

People return because the underlying interaction remains useful. A round starts quickly. Progress is visible. Failure is understandable. A new attempt creates a different arrangement without requiring a tutorial.

This is also why many attempts to modernise classic games go too far. Extra animations, reward systems and crowded menus can obscure the quality that made the original work. Solitaire does not need to pretend to be bigger than it is. Its modest scale is part of the appeal.

The browser is the new family computer The family computer once gathered software in a single physical place. Today, the browser performs a similar role across laptops, tablets and phones. It provides a common surface where a familiar game can appear without installation or a long setup process.

That shift changes access, but not the core experience. A card still needs a clear destination. A sequence still needs to be read. The player still chooses between an immediate move and a more patient plan.

Browser play also preserves another old habit: using a simple game as a boundary between tasks. One round can mark the end of work, fill a short wait or provide a calm reset before returning to something more demanding.

Why the old rhythm survives Computer solitaire lasts because its rhythm was never tied to one machine. It begins with disorder, asks for careful attention and rewards the gradual creation of structure. The interface supports that rhythm without getting in the way.

That is a useful lesson from classic software. Technology becomes memorable when it gives people a clear action, a reliable response and enough space to make their own decisions. Solitaire did that on the early desktop, and it continues to do it in the browser today.

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(function(d, s, id) { var js, fjs = d.getElementsByTagName(s)[0]; if (d.getElementById(id)) {return;} js = d.createElement(s); js.id = id; js.src = "//connect.facebook.net/en_US/all.js#xfbml=1"; fjs.parentNode.insertBefore(js, fjs); }(document, 'script', 'facebook-jssdk'));
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GAME anuncia GAME Legend, un reconocimiento a los clientes más históricos de la cadena

GAME celebra la gran acogida de GAME Premium durante las primeras 24 horas y anuncia GAME Legend, el reconocimiento a los clientes más fieles y que llevan comprando más tiempo.



Tras el anuncio de GAME Premium, la cadena de tiendas acaba de presentar GAME Legend, como respuesta al elevado volumen de suscripciones que ha tenido la iniciativa en sus primeras 24 horas, que ha triplicado las expectativas que GAME había previsto. Por eso, desde GAME quieren dar las gracias a su comunidad por la acogida de GAME Premium, la nueva membresía anual con la que apuestan por construir nuevas ventajas para sus clientes, basadas en las propias prioridades que han expresado.

GAME Premium ha nacido tras un proceso de escucha a miles de clientes durante varios meses, a los que se encuestó y entrevistó para conocer qué querían y cómo lo querían. Envíos gratuitos ilimitados, puntos dobles, descuentos y ventajas exclusivas forman parte de una propuesta concebida para portar valor a quienes eligen GAME de forma recurrente. “Una forma de agradecer a quienes han acompañado durante buena parte de nuestros más de 40 años de historia y que viene de antes incluso de ser GAME, con Centro MAIL y One Way Software”.

GAME LEGEND y el 25º aniversario de GAME Todo esto, coincidiendo con un año especialmente significativo para GAME, ya que celebran su 25 aniversario siendo GAME. Por eso, quieren que esta celebración también tenga memoria, y por este motivo han lanzado GAME LEGEND.

Se trata de un reconocimiento especial a aquellos clientes que destacan por su trayectoria, antigüedad y fidelidad a GAME. Los clientes GAME LEGEND recibirán una tarjeta conmemorativa especial y un año de GAME PREMIUM como regalo*. Una forma de agradecer a los clientes más fieles en sus más de 40 años de historia y que viene de antes incluso de ser GAME, con Centro MAIL y One Way Software.

Una forma de dar las gracias Para GAME, PREMIUM representa una nueva forma de devolver y aportar más valor a su comunidad. LEGEND, por otro lado, representa algo más sencillo: una forma de dar las gracias. Gracias a quienes acaban de confiar en esta nueva propuesta, y gracias a quienes llevan años confiando en GAME.

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Final Fantasy VII Revelation ya se puede reservar en formato físico en GAME, incluyendo la impresionante Deluxe Edition para PS5, Switch 2 y Xbox

GAME abre las reservas de Final Fantasy VII Revelation, la tercera entrega de la trilogía que llegará el 8 de abril de 2027, tanto de su edición estándar como de la Deluxe Edition para PS5, Switch 2 y Xbox.



El épico final de la trilogía de Final Fantasy VII Remake ya tiene fecha de lanzamiento. Será el 8 de abril de 2027 cuando Final Fantasy VII Revelation aterrice en PC y consolas, y en GAME se han anticipado a todos para abrir reservas de sus ediciones físicas. Final Fantasy VII Revelation ha presentado su increíble Deluxe Edition, que viene con el juego en formato físico y montones de extras, aunque es una pena que todas las versiones requieran de una descarga de contenido (es una tarjeta llave en Switch 2, por cierto).

Sea en su web o en cualquier tienda de la cadena, GAME anuncia que ya se puede reservar Final Fantasy VII Revelation para PS5, Nintendo Switch 2 y Xbox Series X, así que no os quedéis sin vuestra copia. Las reservas de FFFVII Revelation ya están activas en GAME, y eso incluye la Deluxe Edition para PS5, Switch 2 y Xbox Final Fantasy VII Revelation tiene dos ediciones físicas distintas: por un lado está la Magic Card Edition, que incluye el juego en disco o cartucho junto a una carta promocional de Final Fantasy Showdown.

Esta edición se puede reservar por solo 3 euros para PS5, Switch 2 y Xbox, y su PVP recomendado es de 81,99 euros. El plato estrella es la Deluxe Edition, que trae el mismo contenido que la Magic Card Edition (el juego físico y la carta), pero con una presentación inmejorable y montones de extras en las tres plataformas.

Ya mismo se puede reservar por solo 5 euros. Su PVP recomendado es de 109,99 euros, y esto es todo lo que trae: Juego base con carátula reversible., Carta promocional "Final Fantasy Final Showdown"., Steelbook exclusiva., Libro de arte tapa dura., Banda sonora física en mini CD.

Ojo, porque las unidades de la Deluxe Edition son muy limitadas, así que corred a por ella porque tiene pinta de que se va a agotar muy pronto. También hay que decir que Final Fantasy VII Revelation no tiene edición física para PC. La de Xbox será compatible con el nuevo sistema de conversión de disco a digital (para que soporte Xbox Play Anywhere, juego en handhelds PC y el juego en la nube).

Las versiones de PS5 y Xbox Series X requieren de una descarga adicional para poder ejecutar el disco, mientras que la de Switch 2 viene en formato Game-Key Card y requiere de descargar todo el contenido desde Internet. Es el juego más grande de la consola hasta la fecha, con más de 130 GB de tamaño.

Final Fantasy VII Revelation pondrá el broche de oro a la trilogía de Cloud, Tifa, Barret y compañía a partir del 8 de abril de 2027 en PS5, Nintendo Switch 2, Xbox Series X|S y PC, pero solo las versiones para consolas tendrán ediciones físicas... ¡Que ya podéis reservar en GAME!

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Everything announced at Sony's State of Play September 2026

It's showcase time! After a packed Gamescom, Sony's doing its own thing once more, this time giving a taste of everything coming to PlayStation 5 in the coming months and beyond. That includes a final look at Marvel's Wolverine before its impending release, another glimpse of Zach Cregger's promising Resident Evil movie (although that's obviously one coming to the big screen), as well as plenty more. We'll be updating as the show goes on... [Read more](#)



It's showcase time! After a packed Gamescom, Sony's doing its own thing once more, this time giving a taste of everything coming to PlayStation 5 in the coming months and beyond. That includes a final look at Marvel's Wolverine before its impending release, another glimpse of Zach Cregger's promising Resident Evil movie (although that's obviously one coming to the big screen), as well as plenty more. We'll be updating as the show goes on...

Yup, a slightly unorthodox way to start the show, but here's a fresh peek at the Resident Evil movie, coming to cinemas on 18th September 2026.

The release of Marvel's Wolverine is just around the corner! You only have to wait until 15th September 2026 for this gory comic book adventure to arrive on PlayStation 5. Become Logan as he fights back against the forces of Deathstrike, Omega Red and more. Sometimes he might even have a friend or two.

Ghost of Y■tei: Complete Edition

Whether you missed Ghost of Y■tei upon its first release or are already a fan, you might want to consider picking up the Complete Edition when it's released on 1st October 2026 for PlayStation 5. This is because it includes Echoes of Sekigahara, a new story expansion, and Most Wanted, a combat survival mode.

Monster Hunter Wilds: Ascendance

Ascendance is the upcoming DLC for Monster Hunter Wilds . Return to the Forbidden Lands and hunt down the mysterious Elder Dragons. Can you defeat them and turn them into a fancy hat? Find out when Ascendance is released in 2027 on PlayStation 5, Xbox Series X/S and PC.

We later got another look at Monster Hunter Wilds - Ascendance during the State of Play Japan segment of the showcase. This includes some words from the game's producer, Ryozo Tsujimoto. If you're a Monster Hunter fan, then it's worth watching!

From the realms of fantasy to the depths of the post-apocalyptic Moscow metro system, State of Play next gave us our first look at Metro 2039 gameplay on the PlayStation 5. Inspired by the book series written by Dmitry Glukhovsky, Metro 2039 sees you battling against a new faction called the Novoreich.

Metro 2039 will be released on 4th February 2027 for PlayStation 5, Xbox Series X/S and PC.

Maneater 2 is a wonderful reminder about why swimming is sometimes not the best of ideas, but at least you get to enjoy playing the shark! Eat humans, attack sea monsters and pull off some sick flips as one of the ocean's deadliest predators.

Maneater 2 will be released in 2027 for PlayStation 5, Xbox Series X/S and PC.

Well here we are! After much chatter, we've got our first look at Crimson Desert's eagerly anticipated DLC. It's called Charting the Unknown and it's out 15th October for PlayStation 5, Xbox Series X/S and PC.

Yup, Sony's not letting Nintendo, Atari, and Sega have all the fun. There's an official Lego PlayStation 1 on the way, and it even has a couple of fun diaramas tucked away inside: one for Gran Turismo and another for Ape Escape. no release date yet though!

Here's a quick look at Final Fantasy Resonance, which is both an adaptation of 2015 mobile game Final Fantasy Brave Exvius (or a bit of it at least) AND the first HD-2D game in the Final Fantasy series. A demo is on the way.

Final Fantasy Resonance will be released on 22nd October 2026 for PlayStation 5, Xbox Series X/S, Nintendo Switch, Nintendo Switch 2 and PC.

Excited for Gundam Rogue Orbit? Well good news: it now has a release date and is out 5th March 2027 on PlayStation 5, Xbox Series X/S and PC. We returned to this game later on in the State of Play Japan showcase where the game's producer, Yuya Tomiyama-san stopped by for a chat.

Something spooky is afoot in Hunter's Moon, an upcoming first-person historical narrative game. Set over the course of one night and inspired by the English witch hunts, you'll play as a woman running through her life.

Hunter's Moon will be released on 26th October 2026 on PlayStation 5.

Uncanyon offers a mixture of exploration and puzzle-based gameplay as you venture out into a nearly forgotten world. Bring this world back to life as you journey through various ruins. (Well sometimes you'll need to return it to ruins to progress...)

Uncanyon will be released in 2027 for PlayStation 5 and PC.

Great news for PS5 players! Double Fine's wonderfully weird lighthouse adventure isn't just heading to Sony's console - it's out today! Keeper is also on PC and Xbox Series X/S.

Curious about Konami's upcoming RPG Rev. NOiR? Then have a gander at this latest trailer. This upcoming fantasy RPG (with what lots like all of the good fantasy RPG staples) will be released in 2027 for PlayStation 5, Xbox Series X/S and PC.

And another one from Konami, this time taking us to the jazz-filled streets of 1920s New York, where magus Ellie Myers is on a mission promising "exhilarating combat and stack up combos with beasts and magick". Rhapsody in Scarlet made a return during the State of Play Japan segment for this showcase when its producer, Takanori Murayama-san, stopped by to talk about the game.

Rhapsody in Scarlet is currently in development and will be released on PlayStation 5, Xbox Series X/S and PC. You'll be able to learn more about the game though during the Konami Press Start livestream on the Konami YouTube channel .

Upcoming PlayStation Plus Games

Here's a quick roundup-within-a-roundup of what's coming to PlayStation Plus!

Saros is getting a free update titled Zenith, promising a New Game+ mode, other assorted "new replayable game modes", and improved accessibility options. It will be released later this year on PlayStation 5.

Gran Turismo Sport's Spec IV update is launching in two parts later this year - the first in October, the second in December - and we've got first details on the new circuits, new cars, Family Mode, and more. Gran Turismo Sport is available on PlayStation 4 and PlayStation 5.

Until Dawn 2 sees you stepping into the shoes of the Dead True ghost-hunting team when they journey to Akishima Island. Though it looks like this reality show has bitten off far more than it can chew as events start getting real. Will you help them survive or cause their deaths?

Until Dawn 2 will be released on January 28th 2027 for PlayStation 5.

Final Fantasy VII Revelation

Does Final Fantasy VII Revelation really need an introduction? This game is the climax to the Final Fantasy VII remake trilogy. Here Cloud and crew will finally, hopefully, defeat Sephiroth!

Final Fantasy VII Revelation will be released on April 8th 2027 for PlayStation 5, Xbox Series X/S, Nintendo Switch 2 and PC.

State of Play Japan then began with the first game being Dragon Ball Xenoverse 3. Take on the roll of your favourite character and punch your way to a power level of over 9,000.

Dragon Ball Xenoverse 3 will be released in 2027 on PlayStation 5, Xbox Series X/S and PC.

Next came a look at Fate/Extra Record, here you'll fight a variety of monsters on your quest to find the Holy Grail in this anime-styled game.

Fate/Extra Record will be released on January 28th 2027 on PlayStation 4, PlayStation 5, Nintendo Switch, Nintendo Switch 2 and PC.

Dragon Quest Monsters: The Withered World

The next game was technically Monster Hunter Wilds - Ascendance, but it seemed a little bit silly to have the same game mentioned twice in the roundup so I've popped some extra info in its original section. After another look at Monster Hunter Wilds, the showcase moved on to Dragon Quest Monsters: The Withered World.

Here you'll follow the adventures of Biana and Nera as they journey through the Kingdom of Witherwood and befriend the monsters to fight alongside them. (And sometimes merge some of them together, which I really hope isn't painful.) If you fancy a break from the storyline, there's also an arena mode for extra battles.

Dragon Quest Monsters: The Withered World will be released on 3rd December 2026 on PlayStation 5, PC, Nintendo Switch, Nintendo Switch 2 and Xbox Series X/S.

The Eminence in Shadow: Phantom Echoes

Well a game based around The Eminence in Shadow was definitely on my bingo card for this showcase. Though I will admit to enjoying this anime and its assets... (Should probably clarify that this is Lottie writing and not Matt.)

The Eminence in Shadow: Phantom Echoes will offer rogue-lite action when it's released in 2027 for PlayStation 5.

Rematch Blue Lock Collaboration

Next we headed to the football pitch with a look at the Rematch Blue Lock Collaboration, which will be released on 24th September 2026 for PlayStation 5, PC and Xbox Series X/S.

It was then time to take a look at Where the Seeds Fall - the first game from developer, CygamesEdge. An action-adventure game, Where the Seeds Fall is definitely a game for people who are comfortable with heights. You'll have to descend down the World Tree, the last refuge of humanity, on your quest to reach the surface.

Where the Seeds Fall will be released on 5th November 2026 for the PlayStation 5.

WPCA: World Phasebound Control Authority

Next we revisited another game previously shown in the showcase - Gundam Rogue Orbit. Like before I've popped that information in its original section. Now that game name is quite the mouthful. WPCA: World Phasebound Control Authority is set in Seoul and sees you hacking-and-slashing your way through different supernatural monsters. (For some reason I'm reminded of another game with the word 'Control' in its title...)

WPCA: World Phasebound Control Authority will be released in 2028 for PlayStation 5 and PC.

It's time for some monster slaying action but with a twist, because, in Stupid Never Dies, you are one of the monsters! Play as a zombie and take on vampires, werewolves and more.

Stupid Never Dies is being released just in time for Halloween on 21st October 2026 (depending on your region, it may be released on 22nd October 2026) for the PlayStation 5 and PC.

SlashZero is an upcoming side-scrolling action roguelike game all wrapped up in some anime style. Here you'll be able to play as a variety of different characters, allowing you to play around with different movesets.

SlashZero will be released in Spring 2027 for PlayStation 5 and PC.

Echoes of Aincrad Genesis Maidens

If you're a fan of Sword Art Online, then you might have played Echoes of Aincrad. If that's the case then look forward to the DLC - Genesis Maidens - arriving in Winter 2026 on PlayStation 5, Xbox Series X/S and PC.

Digimon Story Time Stranger: A Hero's Eternal Legacy DLC

Did you enjoy Digimon Story Time Stranger? Well, good news for you! The DLC, A Hero's Eternal Legacy is on its way. Set three years after the end of the base game, this DLC will follow a whole new protagonist and bring 50 new Digimon to the game.

The A Hero's Eternal Legacy DLC for Digimon Story Time Stranger will be released in 2027 on PlayStation 5, Xbox Series X/S and PC.

Conq: Crown of No Quarter

The dead have risen in Conq: Crown of No Quarter. Here you'll fight both at land and at sea to discover who will be victorious in this mixture of real time strategy and tactical RPG. Conq: Crown of No Quarter will be released in 2027.

Once again State of Play Japan took another look at some previously shown games - Rhapsody in Scarlet and Rev. NOiR in this game - so let's grab straight to the next new title.

Daba: Land of Water Scar is set in a world lacking water (probably where the whole 'water scar' thing is coming from). You'll play as a clayman - a creature which should most definitely not be awake - and venture out into the world. This journey, of course, involves a lot of violence.

Daba: Land of Water Scar will be released in Spring 2027 for the PlayStation 5.

Ghost of Y■tei: Complete Edition - Echoes of Sekigahara Narrative Trailer

While Ghost of Y■tei has already made an appearance quite close to the beginning of this roundup, I thought that a nice way to end it would be this narrative trailer.

Hope you enjoy this State of Play and State of Play Japan!

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Crítica de The Gentlemen temporada 2: Guy Ritchie regresa por sus fueros a Netflix

Crítica de la segunda temporada de The Gentlemen: La serie, de estreno en Netflix el 3 de septiembre.



Hemos visto los ocho episodios que componen la segunda temporada de The Gentlemen: La serie y que aterrizan en la plataforma Netflix hoy mismo. La buena nueva es que sigue despertando interés por la evolución de los personajes y que ya se ha renovado por una tercera temporada (el desenlace desde luego deja las cosas en un momento crítico), la no tan buena es que el listón sigue estando más bien bajo en lo que se refiere a la acción.

Ya comentamos a propósito de la primera temporada que se percibía como un producto menor respecto a la película. Ahora podemos asegurar que la línea es continuista en este sentido: no estamos ante el mejor Guy Ritchie. Sin embargo, ya nos hemos familiarizado con la galería de personajes y con el tono de la serie, que en esta ocasión apunta más alto, casi a hermanarse con El padrino y a abrazar el juego de contrastes entre los lujos, privilegios y supuesto acervo de la aristocracia y las familias de gánsteres, sicarios y personajes arribistas que amenazan con su caos el aparente orden que los primeros proponen... siempre a beneficio de sus abultados bolsillos.

Lo primero que hay que señalar es que la historia da muchas vueltas y a veces se recrea demasiado en subtramas que no van a ninguna parte. A este director venía acompañándole un sello autoral caracterizado por la mezcla de humor negro, diálogos elocuentes y secuencias de acción estilizadas pero, de un tiempo a esta parte, le cuesta encontrar el balance entre estos ingredientes y ofrece cada vez menos de lo que nos gusta.

Es decir que se recrea en el envoltorio pero mengua lo que mete dentro de él. A la serie The Gentlemen le falta algo de garra, que no violencia. Por otra parte, recalca en los mismos problemas que ya vimos en la primera temporada: los personajes son bastante ásperos y al protagonista, Theo James, le falta registro interpretativo.

Da el tipo, sin lugar a dudas, y cumple tanto en el apartado de la acción como en el del estilismo, parte fundamental para un personaje adinerado y engreído como es el duque, pero su arco de evolución es la piedra de toque de toda la temporada y no alcanza a mostrar todo el rango de emociones que son necesarias para generar una respuesta empática en la audiencia.

Le falta carisma, no proyecta y se lo siguen comiendo con patatas otros intérpretes que tiene a su alrededor, desde Kaya Scodelario hasta Ray Winstone. Por lo demás la segunda temporada de *The Gentlemen* se detiene bastante en las vidas sentimentales de los protagonistas y se recrea en tensiones sexuales no resueltas a la par que estira una relación cuyo final es muy fácil adivinar.

El factor sorpresa juega en contra de una temporada que se percibe de bisagra y que, de alguna forma, se las apaña para dar un rodeo gigantesco para dejarnos en la rampa de salida de nuevo. Para eso aparta a uno de los personajes principales del foco dejándolo casi en el olvido para retomarlo al final.

En fin, a pesar de las muchas pegas que se le pueden poner a la serie, la puesta en escena sigue siendo impecable. Pocas pegas se le pueden poner al montaje y al trabajo del director en sí mismo. En verdad lo que más chirría es el guión en sí mismo, el diseño de los personajes, la cantidad de relleno de la historia y ciertos clichés que se cuelan incluso en los diálogos, a los que les falta chispa.

La sofisticación enfrentada al mundo criminal hace tiempo que dejó de ser original y definitivamente la serie sufre para mantener el interés en los personajes, que ni son tan verosímiles como para despertar una reflexión sobre la realidad ni tan fascinantes como para sustentar los soliloquios delirantes del personaje de Giancarlo Esposito.

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